

March 20, 2026

The Honorable Laura Swett, Chairman
The Honorable David Rosner, Commissioner
The Honorable Lindsay See, Commissioner
The Honorable Judy Chang, Commissioner
The Honorable David LaCerte, Commissioner

Federal Energy Regulatory Commission
888 First Street, N.E.
Washington, D.C. 20426

Re: *Docket No. RM26-4-000*

Dear Chairman Swett and Commissioners Rosner, See, Chang, and LaCerte:

We are entering a period of load growth unprecedented in recent memory, driven by data centers that support our daily lives and advance North America's leadership in the deployment of artificial intelligence. The North American Electric Reliability Corporation ("NERC") recognizes the urgency we are facing. We need significant investment in infrastructure and energy resources to meet our transforming resource and energy needs. At the same time, we must stay laser-focused on reliability, informed by NERC's analysis of grid events in Virginia and Texas, where large data center loads have responded to, and amplified, grid instability.¹ We understand we must quickly secure the reliable contribution of these loads to the future system, especially given the lessons learned related to the integration of inverter-based resources. As a result, NERC is currently processing many tasks in parallel to address large load integration, rather than in sequence as we normally would. We believe this is the most appropriate way to enable data center growth and reliable integration with the grid.

In October of 2025, the Department of Energy ("DOE") issued an Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking *Ensuring the Timely and Orderly Interconnection of Large Loads*² that directed the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (the "Commission") to initiate proceedings to enable the interconnection of large loads. The Commission issued a Notice Inviting Comments,³ and in November, NERC submitted a filing to support the Commission's consideration of how to best ensure that the Bulk Power System ("BPS") is prepared to integrate large loads in a way that sustains reliability.⁴ NERC included a timeline for its large load action plan.

NERC respectfully submits this supplement to: (i) update the Commission on NERC activities over the last quarter; and (ii) provide NERC's accelerated large load action plan. Under the accelerated large load action plan, NERC intends to file revised registry criteria and Reliability Standards on or before December 31, 2026. NERC also plans a Level 3 Alert in early May of 2026 to urge essential actions in the interim.

¹ Incident Review Considering Simultaneous Voltage-Sensitive Load Reductions (Jan. 8, 2025), https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/our-work/reports/event-reports/incident_review_large_load_loss.pdf.

² *Ensuring the Timely and Orderly Interconnection of Large Loads, Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking*, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 27, 2025) [hereinafter ANOPR]; 42 U.S.C. § 7173(a).

³ *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System, Notice Inviting Comments*, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 27, 2025).

⁴ *Comments of the N. Am. Elec. Reliability Corp. in Response to Notice Inviting Comments*, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Nov. 21, 2025).

This expedited, multi-pronged approach is based on NERC reliability assessments and stakeholder feedback. In February of 2026, NERC held a large load technical conference to discuss crucial questions and findings, and to continue building meaningful engagement with stakeholders on this issue. The technical conference included NERC's presentation on the results of January responses to NERC's Level 2 Alert (which provided recommendations for large load integration). After hearing from participants, NERC concluded that it would accelerate the large load action plan and initiate efforts to update its registry criteria and develop initial Reliability Standards to include large loads. These updates would provide certainty on which parties should be subject to NERC requirements (per updated registry criteria) and what those parties should be required to do (per updated Reliability Standards). Additional Reliability Standard revisions are also anticipated in the future under NERC's stakeholder process.

In addition, on March 11, 2026, NERC's Reliability and Security Technical Committee (the "RSTC") approved the Large Loads Working Group's ("LLWG") second whitepaper, *Assessment of Gaps in Existing Practices, Requirements, and Reliability Standards for Emerging Large Loads*.⁵ The findings in this whitepaper, as well as the public report on the Level 2 Alert, further reflect the need for registry criteria and Reliability Standard updates. The Level 2 Alert report also underscored the need for a Level 3 Alert to urge essential actions and provide guidance while registry criteria and Reliability Standards are modified.⁶ A Level 3 Alert and guidance materials throughout 2026 via NERC and its subgroups will ensure that risk mitigation starts right away, while the appropriate regulatory process works to deliver the necessary updates to registration and standards.

Finally, on March 18, 2026, the NERC Standards Committee ("SC") appointed a standard drafting team, accepted a Standard Authorization Request ("SAR") for computational load, and authorized the SAR for posting.⁷ The SAR proposes Glossary updates for computational load and computational load entities along with a new Reliability Standard focused on essential actions for integrating large computational loads in the near term.

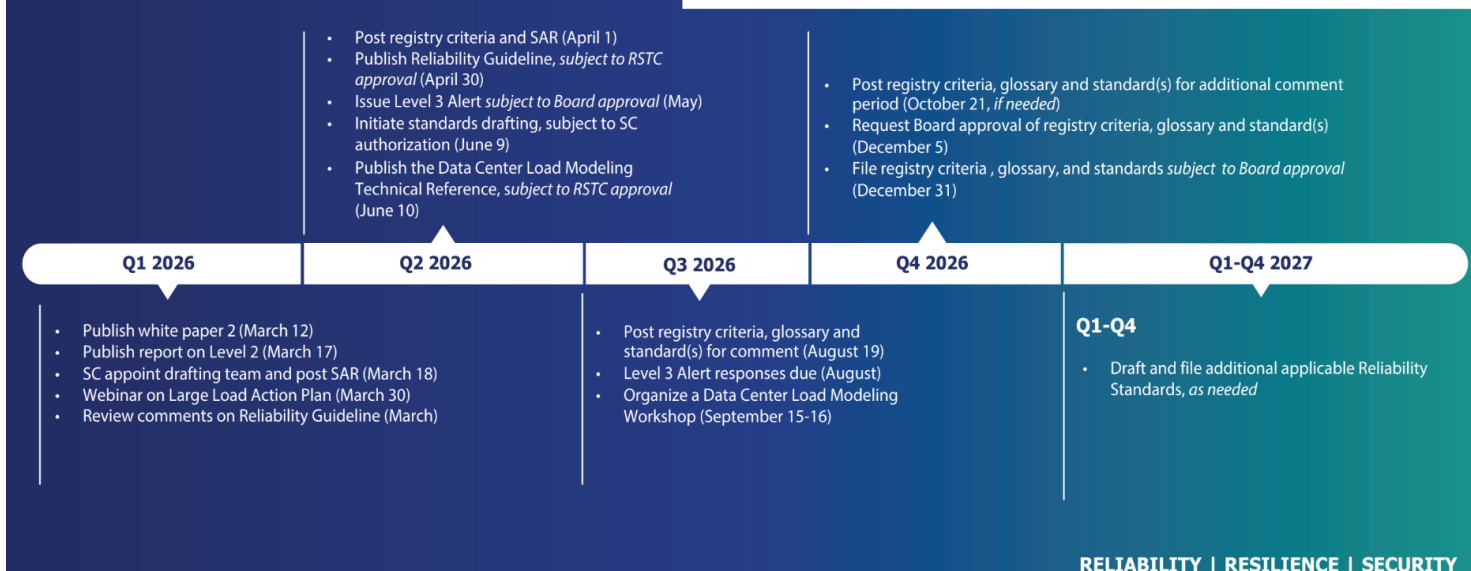
The past quarter has primed NERC and stakeholders for redoubled effort to address the reliability needs associated with large load integration. NERC is committed to identifying and mitigating risks to the BPS so that the grid continues to support the North American economy and innovation. The following depicts the accelerated large load action plan with stakeholder feedback each step of the way.

⁵ NERC Large Loads Working Group, *Assessment of Gaps in Existing Practices, Requirements, and Reliability Standards for Emerging Large Loads* (March 2026), <https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/our-work/guidelines/reliability/white-paper---assessment-of-gaps.pdf>.

⁶ Aggregated Report on NERC Level 2 Industry Recommendation: Large Load Interconnection, Study, Commissioning, and Operations (March 2026) <https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/programs/bpsa/alerts/2025/aggregated-report-level-2-large-load-interconnection-study-commissioning-and-operations.pdf>.

⁷ NERC Standards Committee, Meeting Agenda (Item 5 Reliability Standards to Address Computational Load - Phase I Standard Authorization Request) (Mar. 18, 2026), https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/who-we-are/standing-committees/sc/20260318_sc_agenda_package.pdf.

Large Load Action Plan: 2026-2027 Timeline



**NERC will maintain an up to date version on its Large Load Action Plan Webpage at <https://www.nerc.com/initiatives/large-loads-action-plan>*

NERC, in partnership with the Regional Entities, is committed to doing our part as the Electric Reliability Organization to enable the rapid growth of these key loads in a manner that preserves—and potentially enhances—reliability for all. The accelerated large load action plan would achieve initial level setting by year-end.

While the pace of development puts pressure on all of us, I want to assure you that NERC and the Regional Entities are working at the pace necessary—which at times can be uncomfortable—to meet the moment and enable the interconnection of large data centers in a manner that preserves reliability. NERC expresses its sincere appreciation to the governmental authorities, large load participants, utilities, other stakeholders, and public as we work together to ensure reliable operation of the BPS. We look forward to working with the Commission and stakeholders, and welcome any feedback that you or your teams may have throughout the process.

Sincerely,



James B. Robb

President and Chief Executive Officer

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